

SnowyKim

Employee Handbook

United States Edition - San Francisco and New York

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This handbook is the primary general reference for employment practices at SnowyKim. It explains how we work, what employees can expect from the company, and what the company expects from employees. It is intentionally broad: detailed benefit plans, location-specific rules, and specialized operating policies may provide additional requirements. When a detailed policy, benefit plan document, written employment agreement, or applicable law conflicts with this handbook, the more specific authority controls.

Nothing in this handbook creates a promise of employment for a fixed period or changes the at-will employment relationship where at-will employment is permitted by law. SnowyKim may revise, suspend, or replace handbook provisions as business needs, legal requirements, or benefit plans change. Material updates will be communicated through the HR portal or company email.

SnowyKim and all people, records, systems, and addresses described in this handbook are fictional and are used for demonstration and testing.

1. Working at SnowyKim

SnowyKim develops practical technology products that help organizations make better decisions, coordinate work, and reduce repetitive administrative tasks. Our teams include engineering, data, product, marketing, sales, finance, human resources, HRIS, information technology, and business operations. Although teams have different goals and working rhythms, employees are expected to act with sound judgment, communicate early when risks emerge, and leave systems better than they found them.

Our mission and operating principles

Our mission is to create trustworthy, useful technology while building a workplace where people can perform high-quality work without unnecessary friction. We evaluate work not only by whether it ships, but also by whether it solves the right problem, protects users and employees, and can be maintained by the people who inherit it. Employees should be willing to challenge assumptions, but they should do so with evidence, respect, and a clear alternative.

SnowyKim uses six operating principles. Be useful means focusing on work that solves a real problem. Think clearly means separating facts, assumptions, and preferences. Own the outcome means following through after the first deliverable. Protect trust means treating employee, customer, and company information carefully. Improve the system means addressing recurring causes rather than repeatedly applying temporary fixes. Make room for others means sharing context, credit, and decision-making space across different backgrounds and working styles.

Employment relationship and employee responsibility

Employment is at will where permitted by law. Either SnowyKim or the employee may end the relationship at any time, with or without advance notice or cause, subject to applicable law. No verbal statement by a manager changes this relationship. Any different arrangement must be written and approved by an authorized executive and HR Admin.

Employees are responsible for reading this handbook, completing required training, following the policies that apply to their role and location, and asking questions when a rule is unclear. A lack of awareness does not excuse conduct that violates a published policy. Managers have an additional duty to escalate reports of harassment, retaliation, safety concerns, suspected fraud, data exposure, or other serious issues rather than attempting to handle them informally.

Communication and decision-making

SnowyKim favors direct, documented communication. Important decisions should identify the owner, intended outcome, timing, known tradeoffs, and next step. Employees should avoid creating unnecessary meetings, but should not rely on scattered private messages for decisions that affect others. When speed is necessary, teams may act with incomplete information, but assumptions and reversibility should be made explicit.

In practice, these principles are intended to guide ordinary decisions, not to function as slogans. An engineer who identifies a security risk should pause and escalate rather than ship silently. A manager who changes a deadline should explain the business reason and update affected partners. An employee who notices a recurring manual process should document the problem, estimate the impact, and propose a manageable improvement. Employees are not expected to solve every problem alone, but they are expected to surface important information and help the right owner act on it.

Good judgment also includes knowing when a decision belongs elsewhere. Legal interpretations, employee medical issues, investigation decisions, compensation exceptions, and security incidents should be routed to the appropriate specialist. SnowyKim values initiative, but initiative does not mean bypassing controls or making commitments outside one's authority. When uncertain, employees should identify what they know, what they do not know, what could go wrong, and who needs to be involved.

2. Employment Practices and Work Expectations

Employees are classified according to scheduled hours, duration of employment, and wage-and-hour status. Full-time employees are generally scheduled for at least 30 hours per week. Part-time employees work fewer than 30 hours. Temporary employees are hired for a defined period or project. Contractors and consultants are not employees and do not receive employee benefits unless their written agreement expressly provides otherwise. Employees are also classified as exempt or nonexempt under applicable wage-and-hour rules.

Hours, timekeeping, and attendance

SnowyKim's standard workweek runs from Monday through Sunday. Most corporate teams maintain core collaboration hours from 10:00 a.m. to 3:00 p.m. in the employee's local time zone, but schedules may differ by department, customer coverage, or operational need. Employees are expected to be available during agreed working hours, attend required meetings, and communicate promptly when illness, emergencies, or delays affect availability.

Nonexempt employees must record all time worked accurately, including work performed before or after a scheduled shift, during a meal period, or from home. Off-the-clock work is prohibited. Overtime should be approved in advance, but all time actually worked must still be reported and will be paid as required by law. Falsifying time records, asking another person to record time, or discouraging accurate reporting may result in corrective action.

Introductory period and role clarity

The first 90 days are an introductory period focused on training, role expectations, access setup, and early feedback. Managers should establish priorities, success measures, and communication norms during the first month. Employees should raise unclear or conflicting expectations early. Completion of the introductory period does not guarantee continued employment or alter at-will status.

Personnel information and records

Employees must keep their legal name, home address, phone number, emergency contact, tax withholding, direct deposit, and dependent information current in the HR system. Changes should be submitted within five business days. Employees may access approved portions of their own personnel record through self-service or an HR request. Access to another employee's record is prohibited unless specifically authorized by role and business purpose.

Personnel information is used for payroll, benefits, workforce planning, legal compliance, safety, and business administration. SnowyKim limits access according to role and may log access to HR systems. Technical access to a system does not create permission to review the employee content stored within it. Employees should report suspected unauthorized access immediately.

Reasonable accommodations

SnowyKim provides reasonable accommodations for qualified individuals with disabilities, sincerely held religious practices, pregnancy-related needs, and other circumstances protected by law. Employees may contact HR directly and do not need to disclose detailed medical information to a manager. SnowyKim will engage in an individualized process, may request appropriate documentation, and will keep accommodation information separate from ordinary personnel records to the extent practicable.

Work expectations should be reasonable and transparent. Managers should avoid creating hidden availability requirements through late-night messages or inconsistent deadlines. Employees are not required to respond outside working hours unless they are assigned to an on-call or emergency function. At the same time, employees should communicate foreseeable constraints before they become urgent and should arrange coverage for approved time away when their role requires continuity.

Employee records must be accurate because they affect payroll, benefits, security, and emergency communication. Employees should review self-service information periodically and report unexplained changes. HR may require supporting documents for legal-name changes, dependent enrollment, or tax-related updates. Records should never be altered to create a misleading employment history, conceal an error, or gain access to a benefit for which the employee is not eligible.

3. Respectful Workplace and Business Conduct

SnowyKim is committed to a workplace free from discrimination, harassment, retaliation, bullying, threats, and other conduct that undermines safety or dignity. These expectations apply in offices, remote workspaces, company events, business travel, messaging platforms, video calls, and interactions with applicants, customers, contractors, and vendors. Conduct can violate company policy even when it does not meet the legal definition of harassment.

Equal opportunity, harassment, and retaliation

Employment decisions are based on qualifications, performance, business needs, and lawful criteria. SnowyKim prohibits discrimination or harassment based on any status protected by applicable law. Prohibited conduct may include slurs, repeated unwanted comments, sexual advances, sharing offensive images, deliberate exclusion, intimidation, or conditioning a workplace benefit on personal or romantic attention.

Employees may report concerns to their manager, HR Staff, HR Admin, or hr@snowykim-demo.com. A person does not have to confront the individual involved before making a report, and may bypass any manager implicated in the concern. SnowyKim prohibits retaliation against anyone who raises a good-faith concern, participates in an investigation, requests an accommodation, or uses protected leave. Good faith does not require the concern to be substantiated after investigation.

Investigations and confidentiality

SnowyKim reviews reports promptly and as impartially as reasonably possible. Employees are expected to cooperate honestly, preserve relevant records, and avoid influencing witnesses. The company will share information only with people who need it to evaluate or respond to the matter, although complete confidentiality cannot be guaranteed. Employees must not access or distribute investigation records unless assigned and authorized.

Conflicts of interest and outside activities

Employees must disclose outside employment, financial interests, vendor relationships, gifts, investments, or personal relationships that could affect business judgment. A potential conflict is not automatically prohibited, but it must be reviewed so safeguards can be established. Employees may not use confidential information, company resources, or working time to benefit an outside business.

Romantic or close personal relationships must be disclosed when one person directly or indirectly influences the other's hiring, pay, promotion, performance rating, assignments, scheduling, or discipline. SnowyKim may change reporting lines or responsibilities to reduce conflicts. Employees may not pressure colleagues to participate in social, political, charitable, or romantic activities.

Standards of honesty and professional behavior

Employees must provide accurate information in business records, expense reports, time records, hiring materials, investigations, and compliance processes. Theft, fraud, bribery, falsification, deliberate misuse of access, threats, violence, or serious dishonesty may result in immediate action. Employees should communicate disagreements directly and respectfully, avoid humiliating or demeaning conduct, and never misuse title or access to obtain personal benefit.

Respectful conduct does not require employees to agree with one another or avoid difficult feedback. Employees may challenge ideas, question decisions, and raise concerns about performance or fairness. The expectation is that disagreement remains focused on work, evidence, and impact rather than personal attacks or social punishment. Repeated interruption, dismissive behavior, mocking accents, circulating private messages, or excluding a colleague from necessary information may be reviewed even when no single incident appears severe in isolation.

Managers are held to a higher standard because their actions influence assignments, pay, visibility, and psychological safety. A manager should not ask an employee to keep a serious concern off the record, promise a particular investigation outcome, conduct an unofficial inquiry into harassment, or retaliate through workload or opportunity changes. Managers should preserve relevant information and contact HR promptly, while continuing to protect the employee from immediate harm where possible.

4. Hybrid Work, Remote Work, and the Workplace

SnowyKim uses a hybrid model for many corporate roles. The default expectation for eligible employees is three onsite days per week, typically Tuesday through Thursday, unless a department has an approved alternative. A role's work arrangement may change because of customer needs, team effectiveness, security requirements, performance concerns, or business operations. Remote work is not a substitute for dependent care or for being unavailable during scheduled working hours.

Remote work standards

Employees working remotely must maintain a reasonably private, safe, and reliable workspace; use company-managed devices; connect through required security tools; and remain reachable during agreed hours. Confidential discussions should not be conducted where they can be overheard. Screens should be positioned to prevent casual viewing, and paper records should not be stored at home unless specifically authorized. Employees are responsible for ordinary home internet and utility costs unless a written policy provides reimbursement.

Occasional work from a cafe, shared workspace, hotel, or other public location is permitted when business needs allow, but employees must use the company VPN, protect screens and conversations, and avoid accessing highly sensitive HR, security, legal, or customer information in public. Public computers and unknown USB devices may never be used for company work.

Working from another location

Employees must obtain written HR approval before relocating, changing their primary work location, or working from another U.S. state for more than 14 consecutive calendar days. Approval is required because location can affect payroll registration, taxes, benefits, workers' compensation, insurance, and employment-law obligations. Employees may not assume that a manager's informal approval is sufficient.

International remote work requires advance approval from HR Admin and Information Security. International requests may be denied because of tax, immigration, export-control, data-access, customer-contract, or security restrictions. Employees should submit requests at least 30 days in advance and should not make nonrefundable arrangements before receiving written approval.

Office access, visitors, and safety

Employees must use their own badge and may not allow another person to enter on their credentials. Visitors must be registered, escorted where required, and limited to approved areas. Lost badges, suspicious visitors, damaged doors, or unusual activity should be reported promptly. Weapons, threats, violence, and working while impaired by alcohol or illegal drugs are prohibited.

Employees should report injuries, hazards, threats, or emergency conditions immediately. In urgent situations, contact local emergency services first. SnowyKim may temporarily close an office or direct employees to work remotely because of weather, safety, public-health, infrastructure, or security conditions. Employees should follow official company messages rather than relying on informal chat speculation.

Hybrid work requires deliberate coordination. Teams should document where decisions are recorded, which meetings require live participation, how urgent requests are handled, and what information must be available asynchronously. Employees who are remote should receive the same material context as employees in the room. Important decisions should not depend on hallway conversations that exclude colleagues. Managers should evaluate outcomes and collaboration rather than using physical visibility as a substitute for performance evidence.

SnowyKim may approve individual exceptions based on disability accommodation, temporary medical need, business travel, caregiving emergencies, or specialized role requirements. These exceptions are reviewed case by case and do not automatically establish a permanent arrangement for the employee or team. Employees should not compare private arrangements or pressure colleagues to explain why they have different schedules. Questions about consistency should be directed to HR without requesting another employee's confidential information.

5. Paid Time Off, Holidays, and Leaves of Absence

SnowyKim provides time away from work to support rest, illness, family responsibilities, civic obligations, and legally protected needs. Leave eligibility and pay depend on employment classification, location, length of service, and the reason for leave. Employees should contact HR early because multiple company, state, and federal programs may overlap. The detailed PTO and Leave Policy controls when it differs from this handbook.

Vacation PTO and scheduling

Full-time employees accrue the equivalent of 20 vacation days per year. Part-time employees accrue vacation proportionally based on scheduled hours. Contractors do not receive SnowyKim PTO. PTO may be requested in hourly increments. Employees should submit planned requests at least two weeks in advance whenever practical and should not make nonrefundable travel arrangements before approval.

Managers evaluate requests based on staffing, deadlines, fairness, prior approvals, and business continuity. A request may be denied or adjusted when too many employees are absent, but managers should not unreasonably discourage employees from taking earned time. Employees may carry over up to 40 hours of unused vacation PTO into the next calendar year unless a location-specific rule requires different treatment.

Sick time and unplanned absence

Sick time may be used for the employee's illness, diagnosis, treatment, preventive care, qualifying family-care needs, or other protected reasons. Employees should notify their manager as soon as practical and provide an estimated return date when possible. Medical details should be provided only to HR, not posted in team channels. Documentation may be requested when permitted by law and reasonably necessary to administer leave.

Holidays and other paid leave

SnowyKim publishes an annual calendar of 11 company holidays. Employees whose roles require holiday coverage will receive scheduling and pay treatment consistent with their classification and applicable policy. SnowyKim also provides bereavement leave, jury-duty leave, military leave, and other paid or unpaid leave as described in detailed policies and applicable law.

Family, medical, and disability leave

Eligible employees may qualify for parental leave, family-care leave, medical leave, pregnancy-related leave, disability benefits, military-family leave, or leave related to domestic violence, stalking, or other protected circumstances. Some leave programs run concurrently. HR will confirm eligibility, required documentation, benefit continuation, pay coordination, and return-to-work requirements.

Employees returning from medical leave may be asked for a fitness-for-duty statement when job-related and permitted by law. Restrictions or accommodation needs should be discussed with HR before the return date. SnowyKim prohibits retaliation for requesting or using protected leave. Misrepresentation or misuse of leave, however, may result in corrective action.

Employees are expected to use time away honestly and to give as much notice as circumstances permit. Managers may ask about expected duration, coverage, and work handoff, but should not demand unnecessary medical detail. When an employee experiences repeated intermittent absences, HR may help determine whether a formal leave or accommodation process is appropriate. Employees should not perform substantial work while on approved medical leave unless HR confirms that limited work is permitted and voluntary.

PTO balances, leave pay, and benefit continuation can be affected by location-specific rules. Employees moving between California and New York should contact HR before the change so accrual and leave administration can be reviewed. A manager cannot promise that unused PTO will be paid, extended, or carried over beyond policy. Any exception must be documented by HR Admin and should be based on a legitimate business or legal reason rather than favoritism.

6. Benefits, Pay, and Employee Support

SnowyKim offers a benefits program intended to support health, financial security, and wellbeing. Eligibility depends on classification, scheduled hours, location, and plan terms. Official plan documents, insurance contracts, and summary plan descriptions control when their terms differ from this handbook. Employees are responsible for completing enrollment by stated deadlines and reviewing payroll deductions for accuracy.

Health and welfare benefits

Eligible employees may enroll in medical, dental, and vision coverage for themselves and eligible dependents. Plans differ in premiums, deductibles, provider networks, and covered services. Depending on the selected plan, employees may also use a health savings account or flexible spending account. SnowyKim may provide basic life insurance, optional supplemental life coverage, and short-term and long-term disability benefits.

Open enrollment is the annual opportunity to review and change benefit elections. Outside open enrollment, changes generally require a qualifying life event such as marriage, divorce, birth, adoption, or loss of other coverage. Employees must submit changes and supporting documents within the applicable deadline. Failure to act on time may require waiting until the next open-enrollment period.

Retirement and wellbeing resources

Eligible employees may participate in SnowyKim's retirement savings program and manage contribution and investment elections through the designated provider. The Employee Assistance Program offers confidential short-term counseling, referrals, and support for personal, family, financial, legal, and work-related concerns. Participation is voluntary and is not reported to managers except where disclosure is required by law or immediate safety concerns apply.

Payroll and compensation

Employees are paid according to the payroll schedule communicated at hire. Pay statements show salary or hours, taxes, benefit deductions, reimbursements, and other adjustments. Employees should review each statement and report errors promptly. SnowyKim will investigate and correct confirmed payroll errors as quickly as practical.

Compensation decisions may consider role scope, skills, experience, performance, internal equity, location, and external market data. Salary bands are internal planning tools and do not guarantee a particular salary, increase, or promotion. Eligibility for bonuses or equity is determined by the employee's offer terms and applicable plan documents. Bonus targets and equity grants are not guarantees of payment or value.

Employee assistance and financial questions

Employees should use the HR service channel for questions about payroll, benefits, leave, or employee records. Sensitive information should not be posted in public or broad team channels. HR Staff may request identity verification before discussing personal records. Employees should never send passwords, authentication codes, full banking credentials, or unencrypted medical records by email.

Benefit choices should be made using the official enrollment materials rather than informal summaries from coworkers or managers. HR can explain enrollment procedures and plan terminology, but employees should consult the insurer or plan administrator for coverage determinations. SnowyKim does not guarantee that a particular doctor, medication, treatment, or claim will be covered. Employees should keep confirmation records after enrollment and promptly compare the confirmation with payroll deductions.

Compensation information is confidential employee information, although employees retain any legal right to discuss their own wages or working conditions. Employees who have access to compensation records because of their role may not browse, compare, or disclose records for curiosity. Payroll corrections, bonus disputes, and equity questions should be documented through the appropriate service channel so that the company can review the governing records, approval history, and plan terms.

7. Performance, Feedback, and Career Development

SnowyKim expects managers and employees to discuss priorities, progress, risks, and development throughout the year rather than relying only on an annual review. Employees are responsible for understanding their role expectations and raising conflicts or unclear priorities. Managers are responsible for providing timely feedback, recognizing strong work, and identifying performance concerns early enough for the employee to respond.

Goals and performance reviews

Formal performance reviews occur annually and may include self-reflection, manager evaluation, peer input, goal outcomes, and calibration across teams. Reviews consider results, quality, judgment, collaboration, communication, ownership, and expectations for the employee's level. Ratings are not determined solely by completing assigned tasks or by a single high-visibility project.

A performance rating is a business assessment, not a permanent label. Employees may ask for examples, expectations, and development guidance. Managers should distinguish between performance gaps, role ambiguity, insufficient resources, and misconduct. SnowyKim may revise goals when priorities change, but should document material changes and explain how they affect evaluation.

Promotions and internal mobility

Promotions recognize sustained performance at the next level, increased scope or complexity, sound judgment, and organizational need. Tenure, effort, or completion of a single project does not guarantee promotion. Promotion recommendations may be reviewed through calibration to improve consistency across teams. Employees who are not promoted should receive clear guidance about remaining gaps and realistic opportunities to demonstrate readiness.

Employees may apply for internal openings when they meet the role's requirements and are in good standing. Employees are encouraged to discuss career interests with their manager, but may contact Recruiting or HR directly when needed. Internal movement must balance employee development with reasonable transition planning for the current team.

Learning and development

Departments may sponsor courses, certifications, conferences, mentoring, coaching, and stretch assignments. Expenses require prior approval and must be job-related. Some programs may include repayment conditions if the employee voluntarily leaves shortly after completion. Employees should share useful learning with their team and apply new skills responsibly rather than treating training as separate from daily work.

Performance improvement and corrective action

When performance or conduct does not meet expectations, SnowyKim may use coaching, written expectations, a performance improvement plan, final warning, suspension, reassignment, or termination. The company is not required to use every step or use steps in a fixed order. Serious misconduct may result in immediate action. Employees are expected to participate honestly in improvement efforts and may contact HR with concerns about fairness, clarity, or retaliation.

Managers should provide feedback that is specific enough to act on. Statements such as 'be more strategic' or 'show more ownership' should be accompanied by examples, expected behavior, and a reasonable opportunity to demonstrate improvement. Employees should ask clarifying questions and summarize agreed next steps in writing. A disagreement with feedback does not excuse ignoring it, but employees may ask HR to review whether expectations are inconsistent, discriminatory, retaliatory, or materially different from the role they were hired to perform.

Career development is a shared responsibility. Managers should discuss plausible next steps and provide access to meaningful work where business conditions allow, but cannot guarantee a promotion, transfer, or particular assignment. Employees should build evidence through sustained outcomes, sound decision-making, and collaboration rather than relying only on visibility or self-promotion. SnowyKim may delay or decline a promotion when the business lacks an appropriate role even if the employee has developed next-level skills.

8. Technology, Generative AI, and Information Security

Company devices, accounts, networks, and software are provided primarily for business use. Limited personal use is permitted when it is lawful, reasonable, secure, and does not interfere with work. Employees should not expect personal privacy when using company systems, subject to applicable law. SnowyKim may monitor, preserve, or review system activity for security, legal, compliance, and operational purposes.

Accounts, devices, and approved software

Employees must use unique passwords, multifactor authentication, and company-approved password management tools. Passwords and authentication codes may never be shared. Devices must be locked when unattended and updated when prompted. Only approved software, browser extensions, cloud services, and storage locations may be used for company work. Requests for new tools should be submitted through IT rather than installed independently.

Generative AI use

Approved enterprise AI tools may be used for brainstorming, drafting, summarization, coding assistance, translation, analysis, and workflow support when the employee reviews the result and complies with data-handling requirements. AI output may be incomplete, biased, insecure, or incorrect. Employees remain responsible for the final work product, decisions, citations, code behavior, and communications sent under their name.

Employees must not place confidential employee records, compensation files, investigation materials, medical information, credentials, customer secrets, source code marked restricted, unreleased financial information, or legally privileged material into public or unapproved AI tools. Employees must also avoid representing AI-generated content as verified fact without review. Automated decisions affecting hiring, promotion, discipline, compensation, or termination require approved processes and meaningful human oversight.

Data classification and sharing

Information should be handled according to sensitivity. Public information may be shared externally when authorized. Internal information is intended for employees and approved partners. Confidential information, including personnel records and customer data, must be limited to people with a legitimate business need. Restricted information, such as credentials, investigation evidence, medical records, and security keys, requires the strongest approved controls.

Employees should verify recipients before sending sensitive information, use approved encrypted channels, and avoid broad sharing links. Access should be removed when no longer needed. Downloading company information to personal accounts, personal cloud storage, or removable media is prohibited unless specifically approved.

Security incidents and reporting

Employees must immediately report suspicious emails, unexpected authentication prompts, lost devices, exposed credentials, accidental disclosures, malware warnings, or unusual system behavior to security@snowykim-demo.com. Prompt reporting is encouraged even when the employee is unsure whether harm occurred. Do not delete evidence, continue browsing unintended data, or attempt an unapproved investigation.

Before using an AI tool, employees should consider both the input and the output. Harmless-looking prompts may reveal sensitive context when combined with names, dates, project descriptions, or copied messages. Generated code may introduce insecure dependencies or licensing issues, and generated summaries may omit qualifications that materially change meaning. Employees should retain source materials and be able to explain how they verified important output. High-impact decisions must not be delegated to an AI system merely because the result appears confident.

Access controls are an organizational safeguard, not a challenge to work around. Employees who cannot open a document should request access through the proper owner rather than asking a colleague to download or forward it. Similarly, employees who receive access accidentally must stop, report the issue, and avoid searching for additional information. SnowyKim may review audit logs to determine whether access was legitimate, excessive, or inconsistent with an employee's role.

9. Company Property, Travel, Expenses, and External Communications

Employees must protect laptops, phones, badges, keys, documents, and other company property from loss, theft, damage, and unauthorized use. Equipment may not be loaned to family or friends. Lost or stolen property must be reported immediately to IT and the employee's manager. SnowyKim may remotely lock or erase company data from a device when access ends or when a security risk exists.

Business travel and expense principles

Business travel must have a legitimate purpose and appropriate approval. Employees should select practical, cost-effective options and exercise the same judgment they would use when spending their own money. The detailed Travel and Expense Policy controls reimbursement. Ordinary reimbursable expenses include economy airfare, standard hotel rooms, ground transportation, mileage, parking, tolls, and reasonable meals connected to approved travel.

Hotel costs should generally remain at or below \$250 per night and meal expenses at or below \$75 per day unless the location, event, or business need justifies an approved exception. First-class travel, luxury upgrades, personal entertainment, minibar charges, traffic violations, companion expenses, and personal purchases are not reimbursable. Alcohol is reimbursable only when specifically approved for a business event and consumed responsibly.

Expense reports and purchasing

Expense reports should be submitted within 30 days and include itemized receipts and a clear business purpose. Managers may reject incomplete, excessive, late, or noncompliant expenses. Employees may not divide purchases to avoid approval limits, use company funds for personal benefit, or approve their own expenses. Company cards must be returned when requested and may be suspended for repeated policy violations.

External statements, social media, and intellectual property

Only authorized employees may speak on behalf of SnowyKim to the media, investors, regulators, or the public. Employees may identify themselves as SnowyKim employees in personal social media use, but should make clear that personal opinions are their own and must not disclose confidential information. Employees should not use company logos, customer names, internal screenshots, or unreleased product details without approval.

Work product created within the scope of employment or using company confidential information or resources is owned by SnowyKim to the extent permitted by law and applicable agreements. Employees must respect third-party copyrights, software licenses, trademarks, and confidential information. Open-source code and external datasets may be used only in accordance with approved review processes and license obligations.

Records retention

Employees must retain business records according to applicable schedules and any legal hold notice. Deleting, altering, concealing, or moving records to avoid review is prohibited. Routine drafts and duplicates may be deleted when no longer needed unless a policy, investigation, audit, or legal hold requires preservation.

Business expenses should be understandable to someone who was not present. Descriptions such as 'meeting' or 'miscellaneous' are insufficient when the purpose is not obvious. Employees should identify the customer, project, event, or business objective and separate personal charges. When a receipt is unavailable, the employee should provide a written explanation rather than creating or altering documentation. Repeated missing receipts or unusual spending patterns may lead to additional review or loss of purchasing privileges.

Public communication can create legal and reputational obligations even when an employee intends to speak casually. Employees should not confirm customer relationships, comment on internal disputes, disclose another employee's status, or speculate about unreleased products. Nothing in this rule is intended to restrict legally protected discussion of wages or working conditions, reporting to government agencies, or other protected activity. Employees uncertain about a speaking invitation, podcast, publication, or media request should contact Communications before participating.

10. Safety, Reporting Concerns, and Corrective Action

SnowyKim is committed to a safe workplace and expects employees to report hazards, injuries, threats, suspicious behavior, data exposure, and other serious concerns promptly. In an emergency, employees should first contact local emergency services and follow building or public-safety instructions. The company may close an office, restrict access, or direct remote work when conditions create a material safety or security risk.

Workplace violence, substances, and fitness for duty

Threats, intimidation, stalking, fighting, weapons, and deliberate damage to property are prohibited. Employees should report restraining orders or safety concerns that may affect the workplace so appropriate precautions can be considered. Employees may not work while impaired by alcohol, illegal drugs, or misuse of medication. Lawful off-duty conduct will be treated consistently with applicable law, but safety-sensitive work requires employees to remain fit for duty.

Reporting channels and non-retaliation

Employees may raise concerns through a manager, HR Staff, HR Admin, Information Security, or another designated channel. Reports may involve harassment, discrimination, retaliation, payroll issues, conflicts of interest, fraud, data access, safety, policy violations, or unethical conduct. Employees do not need proof before reporting, but should provide information honestly and avoid knowingly false statements.

SnowyKim prohibits retaliation for making a good-faith report, participating in an investigation, requesting an accommodation, discussing working conditions as protected by law, or using protected leave. Retaliation can include termination, demotion, threats, exclusion, schedule manipulation, reduced opportunities, or pressure to withdraw a concern. Suspected retaliation should be reported immediately.

Corrective action

SnowyKim may use coaching, warnings, performance plans, suspension, access restrictions, reassignment, or termination to address conduct or performance. The company is not required to use progressive discipline or follow steps in a fixed sequence. The response depends on seriousness, impact, intent, prior history, consistency, cooperation, and legal obligations. Serious misconduct, including violence, theft, fraud, deliberate data misuse, or severe harassment, may result in immediate termination.

Employee questions and resolution

Employees are encouraged to raise questions before a situation becomes urgent. Managers should answer routine questions or connect employees with the appropriate resource. HR can clarify policy, review employee records, coordinate leave and accommodations, and help resolve workplace concerns. Information Security handles suspicious activity, account compromise, and data incidents. Payroll and benefits questions should be submitted through the HR service channel so the request can be tracked and verified.

Nothing in this handbook prohibits employees from reporting possible violations to a government agency, participating in an agency investigation, discussing wages or working conditions as protected by law, or engaging in other legally protected activity. Employees are not required to notify SnowyKim before making a protected external report.

When a concern is reported, employees should avoid conducting their own surveillance, accessing records outside their role, recording conversations unlawfully, or confronting witnesses in a way that could affect the review. Employees may preserve messages and documents already available to them and should provide those materials to the assigned reviewer. SnowyKim may place temporary restrictions on access, reporting relationships, travel, or workplace contact while a concern is evaluated; these measures are not necessarily disciplinary findings.

Corrective action is intended to protect employees, customers, and the business while addressing behavior or performance. Consistency does not always mean identical outcomes because circumstances differ, but similarly serious situations should be evaluated using comparable factors. HR may review prior practice, the employee's role, the degree of harm, whether the conduct was intentional, and whether the employee accepted responsibility. Confidentiality obligations may limit what the company can explain about action taken against another person.

11. Separation from Employment and Handbook Administration

Employment may end through resignation, retirement, completion of a temporary assignment, position elimination, discharge, or another business decision. Employees who resign are encouraged to provide at least two weeks' written notice, although a longer transition may be appropriate for senior or specialized roles. SnowyKim may accept a resignation immediately, adjust the final working date, or limit system access during the notice period.

Final pay, benefits, and company property

Final wages will be paid according to applicable law and the regular payroll process. Treatment of unused PTO depends on location and policy. Benefit coverage may end on the last day worked, at the end of the month, or on another plan-defined date. HR will provide information about continuation options when applicable. Employees remain responsible for reviewing final pay statements and maintaining a current mailing address for tax documents.

All laptops, phones, badges, keys, documents, purchasing cards, equipment, and other company property must be returned by the date specified. Employees must not retain confidential information, customer data, source code, employee records, or copies of internal documents after separation. SnowyKim may disable accounts immediately and may remotely remove company data from managed or approved personal devices.

Continuing obligations

Confidentiality, intellectual-property, data-protection, and other continuing obligations remain in effect after employment ends according to policy and signed agreements. Former employees may not use or disclose confidential information, represent that they still act for SnowyKim, or access company systems. Requests for employment verification should be directed to HR.

Policy hierarchy and changes

This handbook provides general guidance. Detailed policies, benefit plan documents, location-specific notices, written agreements, and applicable law may provide additional or different rules. When sources conflict, the more specific and authoritative source controls. SnowyKim may revise this handbook at any time. Employees will be notified of material changes and may be required to acknowledge updated versions.

Employee acknowledgment

Employees are expected to acknowledge that they received access to the handbook, understand that it is not an employment contract, and agree to follow applicable policies. An acknowledgment confirms receipt and understanding; it does not waive rights provided by law. Questions about any provision should be directed to hr@snowykim-demo.com before the employee acts on an assumption.

After separation, employees may contact HR for tax forms, benefit continuation information, or employment verification. HR generally confirms dates of employment and position unless the employee authorizes additional information or law requires disclosure. Former employees should not contact active employees for confidential records, access assistance, or internal system information. Questions about continuing confidentiality or property obligations should be directed to HR.

Quick reference contacts

General HR, records, leave, accommodations	hr@snowykim-demo.com
Security incidents and suspicious activity	security@snowykim-demo.com
IT access, devices, and software	it@snowykim-demo.com
Benefits and enrollment	benefits@snowykim-demo.com
Payroll questions	payroll@snowykim-demo.com
Emergency	Local emergency services, then your manager or HR

Demonstration disclaimer: SnowyKim is a fictional company. This handbook is designed for an HR chatbot and role-based retrieval demonstration and is not legal advice.